



MSC World America — Solo Edition

December 5 – 12, 2026 · Sailing solo

Ship: MSC World America · **Sailing from:** MSC Miami Cruise Terminal · **Cabins:** _____

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#): the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers cabins, packing, budget, ship orientation, ports in depth, MSC's quirks, and the solo rhythm.

Day by day

Times are from this sailing's own MSC for Me itinerary (retrieved 2026-08-20). Re-verify in the app close to sailing.

#	Date	Port	Hours ashore	Dock/Tender	Worth knowing
1	Sat Dec 5	PortMiami — embarkation	board 11:30 AM – 3:30 PM; depart 5:00 PM	—	Walk the ship and find your muster station. Sailaway at the World Promenade (Deck 8 aft).
2	Sun Dec 6	Cruising at sea	—	—	Settling-in day. Possible Gala Evening; specialty dining slots open.
3	Mon Dec 7	Roatán, Honduras	~9:00 AM – 6:00 PM	dock at Coxen Hole (Port of Roatán)	West Bay Beach + reef snorkel. December is the tail of the rainy season (rain 3 days in 4): loose plan, dry bags.
4	Tue Dec 8	Costa Maya, Mexico	~8:00 AM – 5:00 PM	dock	Easiest day of the week: walk from ship to the free pool complex, or Chacchoben ruins (~\$50 indep).
5	Wed Dec 9	Cozumel, Mexico	~9:00 AM – 7:00 PM	dock (Punta Langosta, Intl, or Puerta Maya)	Chankanaab (~\$50): calmest snorkel, good alone. Palancar for confident swimmers if no norther.
6	Thu Dec 10	Cruising at sea	—	—	Recovery day. Second Gala likely. Laundry round; book any Ocean Cay cabana tonight.
7	Fri Dec 11	Ocean Cay (Bahamas)	8:00 AM – 8:00 PM (late departure)	dock alongside	South Beach swim lagoon (always people around). 8 PM departure means the lighthouse evening show is in play; check the daily program.
8	Sat Dec 12	PortMiami — debarkation	off by 10:00 AM	—	Uber to MIA ~\$30–45. Home thirteen days before Christmas.

Possible Gala Evenings: typically the two sea-day evenings (Day 2 + Day 6). Smart-casual otherwise; **MSC's dress culture is European-casual**. One nicer outfit covers both.

MSC for Me app runs everything: daily program, dining bookings, account balance, deck plans. **Download and log in before sailing.**

Currency aboard: USD. **Service Charge (gratuity):** \$17/day standard (\$23 Yacht Club) as of May 11, 2026.

December weather, in one line: Miami mild and dry (78/65) · Roatán warm and often wet (81/77) · Mexican ports warm with shower odds (81–82/74) · Ocean Cay pleasant Bahamian winter (76/72). Normals from the 2020–2024 archive; the real forecast lands in the companion PWA ~16 days out. **Pack light layers and rain shells.**

Decide before you board. Run the [drink-calculator](#) on real drinking patterns, the [budget-calculator](#) for your total (sailing alone, nothing gets split), and the [tipping-calculator](#) for Service Charge + cash tips — MSC mid-sail upgrades cost more per day.

Getting to the ship and getting home

Arrival: Friday recommended, Saturday required

Friday, December 4: fly in. Same-day flights to an afternoon all-aboard are risky, and December adds front-driven delays across the eastern seaboard. Pre-cruise hotel in Brickell, Downtown Miami, or Miami Beach.

Saturday, December 5: embarkation.

- **Terminal: MSC Miami Cruise Terminal** at PortMiami, the MSC-built terminal that opened April 2025. *Different from where Royal Caribbean and Carnival board.* Verify the address in the MSC for Me app.
- **MIA → MSC Terminal:** Uber/Lyft \$30–45, 20–30 min. Taxi flat-rate \$32.
- **FLL → MSC Terminal:** Uber/Lyft \$60–90, 45–60 min.
- **If driving:** Terminal garage ran **\$35/day** (~\$245/week, firsthand May 2026; verify); offsite lots \$7–14/day with shuttle. Weigh the shuttle against the garage's walk-on convenience.
- **Embark window:** 11:30 AM – 3:30 PM. Departure 5:00 PM (MSC app); be aboard with an hour's margin.
- **Online check-in via MSC for Me:** done at home, it beats a 20-minute queue.

Day 8 debark and the trip home

- **The night before:** bags in the hall by ~11 PM with the color-coded tag, or carry your own and walk off in the first wave (alone with one bag, seriously consider it).
- **6:00 – 8:00 AM:** Breakfast at Il Mercato or La Brasserie.
- **~7:00 AM:** Arrival + customs clearance. Self-disembarkation begins.
- **7:30 – 10:00 AM:** Walk-off in waves. All passengers off by 10:00 AM.

Carry-on on debark morning: change of clothes, all medications, passports, chargers, valuables.

PortMiami → MIA: Uber/Lyft **\$30–45, 25–30 minutes**; pre-book against Saturday surge. Domestic flight after 4 PM → leave the port by 1:30 PM; MIA TSA runs 30–60 min in the Saturday return rush.

Killing hours before an evening flight: Bayfront Park / Bayside Marketplace (10-min walk) · Pérez Art Museum (\$20, air-conditioned) · Brickell by short Uber.

Areas of interest during the cruise

On the ship: World America spots worth knowing

- **The World Promenade** (Deck 8 aft) — the open-air promenade around the Y-shaped stern. Signature space; December evenings up here want a light layer.
- **The World Galleria** (Decks 6–8 mid-ship) — three-deck LED-ceiling atrium. The easy place to meet up with people you’ve met aboard.
- **Jaw Drop @ The Spiral** — 11-deck dry slide, Deck 20 down to Deck 8; MSC bills it as one of the longest at sea. Shortest lines early in the day; hours in the app.
- **The Harbour Aquapark** — waterslides (including a 90-degree vertical drop) and a splash area; hours and height limits in the app.
- **Cliffhanger @ The Harbour** — the only over-water swing at sea; four seats, ~160 ft above the water. Check the app for cost/height rules before promising a turn.
- **Aurea Spa thermal suite** — sea-day intro rates; ~90 minutes is the right dose.
- **La Brasserie** (Deck 19) — 24/7 French-style casual; the calm breakfast.
- **Luna Park Pizza & Burger** (Deck 6) — the quick-dinner fallback, included.

Sea-day priorities (Day 2 + Day 6)

1. **Sunrise coffee at the World Promenade** — the ship still quiet, wake unfolding below.
2. **Jaw Drop first thing** — the shortest line of the day.
3. **Trivia or a port talk** — the easiest rooms aboard to start a conversation in.
4. **Eataly at lunch** if dinner is booked out.
5. **Port talk for tomorrow’s destination** — the Roatán one especially (weather + logistics).

Specialty dining picks

- **Eataly** (Deck 8) — first Eataly at sea. **Book on Day 1.**
- **Kaito Teppanyaki** — the showy hibachi room; grills are usually shared with other guests, an easy dinner alone.
- **Paxos** (Deck 8) — Greek seafood on the Promenade.
- **Butcher’s Cut** — steakhouse.

Port-day picks (one each)

- **Roatán** — West Bay Beach via taxi (\$6–10/person each way), reef 30 yds offshore. Backup: Gumbalimba Park (monkeys + zipline) if rain reshapes the day.
- **Costa Maya** — the pool complex inside the gated port, free with cruise cards; five minutes from re-boarding.
- **Cozumel** — Chankanaab Beach Adventure Park (~\$50) for calm snorkeling with people around; Palancar (~\$50 indep) for confident swimmers on a calm day.
- **Ocean Cay** — the South Beach swim lagoon (calm, and always people around); Beach Shack lunch 11–4; Marine Conservation Center free tour, the best half-hour of ocean stewardship on the itinerary. No cell service all day: tell your person at home the day before.

The lighthouse show at Ocean Cay

Runs only on overnight or late-departure calls, and this sailing’s MSC-app window (8 AM – 8 PM) IS a late departure, with December darkness by ~5:30 PM. Whether it runs on your call is up to the ship’s program, so check aboard. If it runs, Lighthouse Bay is the seating area.

Photo spots worth knowing

- **World Promenade Deck 8 aft sailaway** — wake beneath the Y-stern, downtown Miami fading in December’s early dusk.
- **The Galleria LED ceiling** — scene changes through the day.
- **Roatán West Bay Beach** — white sand, turquoise, reef offshore (rain-washed light can be the best of the week).
- **Ocean Cay striped lighthouse** at golden hour — Lighthouse Bay beach has the angle.
- **Gala night** — the one night you’re dressed up; get the picture.

Need an at-home emergency handoff card? Separate one-page doc in the voyage-packs folder. The full Voyage Pack is the unabridged companion document. Soli Deo Gloria.